

Here you will find a range of resources that can help with your due diligence process. This page will be updated as new resources become available.

We have developed the following guidance material to help you understand and meet your due diligence requirements under Australia’s illegal logging laws.

This guidance material aligns with the legislation and the way we conduct compliance assessments, audits and issue Requirements to Give Information and Produce Documents notices. It is the only departmentally endorsed guidance material and you should exercise caution when relying on other guidance resources.

We welcome your feedback on the guidance material so we can continue to refine and improve these resources into the future. You can provide feedback via email to illegallogging@aff.gov.au.

Download

[Your responsibilities as a processor – fact sheet \(PDF 248 KB\)](#) [Your responsibilities as a processor – fact sheet \(DOX 233 KB\)](#)

[Illegal logging Due Diligence Toolkit for Processors \(PDF 605 KB\)](#) [Illegal logging Due Diligence Toolkit for Processors \(DOCX 674 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

State Specific Guidelines (SSGs) outline the legal frameworks used in each Australian state to regulate timber harvesting. They provide information to help you determine the risk of illegal logging for raw logs grown and processed in Australia. Each SSG is accompanied by a Quick Reference Guide, which provides a high-level overview of the SSG’s content.

SSGs currently endorsed by the Australian Government are provided below. We continue to work with state jurisdictions to routinely update SSGs. If a SSG for a particular state is not provided below, it either has not yet been developed or is no longer departmentally endorsed.

Prior to March 2025, our illegal logging laws provided a specific SSG risk assessment method. This is no longer the case. The legislation now provides two risk assessment pathways: one for certified timber, timber products, and raw logs and one for non-certified timber, timber products, and raw logs. From March 2025, you are still required to consider the content of relevant SSGs when undertaking your risk assessment for non-certified timber, timber products and raw logs.

SSG documents still reference the outdated legislation in the preambles. The process involved in updating these documents takes some time while we work with our state counterparts to address this.

New South Wales State Specific Guideline

Superseded document in effect until 12 August 2023	File size	Released	Revised
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New South Wales State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	293 KB	October 2014
New South Wales State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	106 KB	October 2014
New South Wales State Specific Guideline PDF	710 KB	October 2014
New South Wales State Specific Guideline DOC	803 KB	October 2014

Document in effect as of 13 August 2023	File size	Released	Revised
Updated New South Wales State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	350 KB	October 2014	September 2022
Updated New South Wales State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	309 KB	October 2014	September 2022
Updated New South Wales State Specific Guideline PDF	726 KB	October 2014	September 2022
Updated New South Wales State Specific Guideline DOCX	675 KB	October 2014	September 2022

Queensland State Specific Guideline

Superseded document in effect until 12 August 2023	File size	Released	Revised
Queensland State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	293 KB	June 2016	
Queensland State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	106 KB	June 2016	
Queensland Specific Guideline (released June 2016) PDF	1.0 MB	June 2016	
Queensland Specific Guideline (released June 2016) DOCX	2.0 MB	June 2016	

Document in effect as of 13 August 2023	File size	Released	Revised
Updated Queensland State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	311 KB	June 2016	June 2022
Updated Queensland State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	876 KB	June 2016	June 2022
Updated Queensland Specific Guideline PDF	925 KB	June 2016	June 2022
Updated Queensland Specific Guideline DOCX	907 KB	June 2016	June 2022

South Australia State Specific Guideline

Document	Released	Revised
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	File size		
South Australia State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	385 KB	October 2014	April 2021
South Australia State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	262 KB	October 2014	April 2021
South Australia State Specific Guideline PDF	3804 KB	October 2014	April 2021
South Australia State Specific Guideline DOC	2815 KB	October 2014	April 2021

Tasmania State Specific Guideline

Document	File size	Released	Revised
Tasmania State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	268 KB	May 2014	December 2021
Tasmania State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	111 KB	May 2014	December 2021
Tasmania State Specific Guideline PDF	1025 KB	May 2014	December 2021
Tasmania State Specific Guideline DOC	1257 KB	May 2014	December 2021

Victoria State Specific Guideline

Superseded document in effect until 12 August 2023	File size	Released	Revised
Victoria State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	425 KB	October 2014	
Victoria State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	129 KB	October 2014	
Victoria State Specific Guideline PDF	582 KB	October 2014	
Victoria State Specific Guideline DOC	1.4 MB	October 2014	

Document in effect as of 13 August	File size	Released	Revised
Updated Victoria State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	349 KB	October 2014	October 2022
Updated Victoria State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	290 KB	October 2014	October 2022
Updated Victoria State Specific Guideline PDF	445 KB	October 2014	October 2022
Updated Victoria State Specific Guideline DOCX	184 KB	October 2014	October 2022

Western Australia State Specific Guideline

Superseded document in effect until 12 August 2023	Released	Revised
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	File size		
Western Australia State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	647 KB	October 2014	
Western Australia State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	188 KB	October 2014	
Western Australia State Specific Guideline PDF	3.1 MB	October 2014	
Western Australia State Specific Guideline DOC	3.8 MB	October 2014	
Document in effect as of 13 August 2023			
	File size	Released	Revised
Updated Western Australia State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	299 KB	October 2014	October 2022
Updated Western Australia State Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	174 KB	October 2014	October 2022
Updated Western Australia State Specific Guideline PDF	440 KB	October 2014	October 2022
Updated Western Australia State Specific Guideline DOCX	238 KB	October 2014	October 2022

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#).

A number of third parties have published material and developed online tools that can be used to inform your due diligence process. We have included a selection, which is not exhaustive, below.

How you use these resources is up to you. However, you need to be aware that you cannot rely on a third party risk assessment to satisfy your due diligence obligations. You still need to undertake your own [due diligence process](#).

If you do use these resources, you should be aware that the information on these websites represents the views of a third party and may not be accurate, up to date, or relevant to your due diligence process.

If you have questions about the information in these resources, you should contact the publisher directly.

Disclaimer:

This content has been prepared to assist timber product importers understand, implement and comply with the requirements of the Illegal Logging Prohibition Act 2012 and the Illegal Logging Prohibition Rules 2024 with respect of their due diligence obligations. It does not constitute legal advice. Timber product importers may elect to seek their own legal advice in relation to the legislation and related matters.

All third-party materials provided on this webpage are intended to be a guide only, and the Australian Government is unable to warrant its currentness, accuracy, completeness or suitability for any purpose. These materials may be subject to further change.

To the maximum extent permitted by law, Australian Government acting through the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry disclaims all liability, including liability for negligence and for any loss, damage, injury, expense or cost incurred by any person directly or indirectly as a result of accessing, using or relying on the information provided on this webpage.

Certification schemes

These resources may assist with the Certified Pathway risk assessment method which relies on forest certification standards as defined in s 4 of the Illegal Logging Prohibition Rules 2024.

[Forest Stewardship Council \(FSC\) – Public Search Database](#)

The FSC maintains a database with information about certificate holders, logo and label users, certified products, and so on. This information can be used to help verify FSC certification claims.

[FSC – Forest Management Certification Standard](#)

The FSC has a forest management certification standard. Their website sets out the principles, criteria and indicators that a forest operation must adhere to before receiving an FSC forest management certification.

[FSC - Chain of Custody Standard](#)

The FSC provides a chain of custody certification. Their website includes information on the core requirements behind this standard.

[Programme for the Endorsement of Forest Certification \(PEFC\) – Public Search Database](#)

The PEFC maintains a database with relevant information about certificate holders, logo and label users, certified products, and so on. This information can be used to help verify PEFC certification claims.

[PEFC – Sustainable Forest Management Standard](#)

The PEFC provides a sustainable forest management standard. Their website sets out the benchmark requirements that must be met to be endorsed by PEFC.

[PEFC - Chain of Custody Standard](#)

The PEFC provides a chain of custody standard. Their website lays out the requirements and conditions a company must meet for chain of custody certification.

Endangered Species

[Australian Government – Trading in endangered species](#)

The Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW)'s website provides advice on the regulatory requirements associated with trading in endangered species, including timber species.

[International Union for Conservation of Nature – Redlist of Threatened Species](#)

The IUCN Redlist of Threatened Species lists plants and animals that are facing a high risk of global extinction. This includes information on geographical ranges and potential vulnerability to illegal logging.

[Environment Protection and Biodiversity Conservation \(EPBC\) Act – List of Threatened Species](#)

This list includes all threatened flora and threatened ecological communities protected under our environmental legislation. This list may not align with state and territory protected species lists, so they are also worth checking for native species.

Timber Legality

[Chatham House – Illegal Logging Portal](#)

The Illegal Logging Portal provides information on the trade in illegal timber. This includes an overview of emerging issues and developments, reports, and a searchable database of global news articles.

[Preferred by Nature – Timber sourcing hub](#)

Preferred by Nature's timber sourcing hub includes national timber legality risk assessments, with information on the risks associated with a particular country, and advice on mitigating actions.

[World Wildlife Fund \(WWF\) Wood Risk Tool](#)

Launched in 2023, the WWF wood risk tool (the tool) aims to help companies and other wood buyers and regulators to assess, understand, and manage risks associated with logging and trade, and contribute to a more sustainable future. The tool provides consolidated information from a range of sources to provide information on origin and species risk.

Other Resources

[Global Timber Tracking Network \(GTTN\) - Service Provider Directory](#)

GTTN's Service Provider Directory provides a system to help anyone seeking wood identification services to find information on scientific methods and available laboratories.

[Preferred by Nature – Guide to identifying fake documents](#)

Preferred by Nature has produced a guide to identifying fake timber documentation. This includes examples of forged documents, ways of distinguishing between genuine and fake documents, and advice on what to do if you encounter fake documents.

[Plants of the World Online \(POWO\) – Seed-bearing plant data](#)

POWO is an international collaborative programme that can provide information on the distribution of all known seed-bearing plants worldwide. The database contains information on taxonomy, identification, distribution (including detailed maps), descriptions, images, traits, threat status (e.g., IUCN Red List data), and uses of plants.

[GlobalTreeSearch – Tree species distribution](#)

GlobalTreeSearch is a database of all the world's known tree species and their country level distributions.

Disclaimer

Some publications, not prepared by us, may not meet [Australian Government accessibility guidelines](#). If you require an accessible version, please contact its author.

Get updates

To receive updates, guidance, and information about upcoming events, subscribe to our [illegal logging mailing list](#).

Illegal logging reporting

Call 1800 803 006

See [Report Illegal Logging](#)

Email [Operational Intelligence and Coordination Branch](#)

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/forestry/policies/illegal-logging/processors/resources>